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LETTERS TO MY SON

On the Steady Mind

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

You cannot govern the world, only your answer to it. These letters are on meeting hardship with an unshaken mind.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Set aside each day to face the things you fear.

Rehearse loss while you still have everything, and loss
loses its power over you.

Practice the hard day on the easy one.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

It is not that we have a short time to live, but that we waste much of it.

Most men are busy with everything except living. Do not be most men.

Spend your days on your life, not on distractions from it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Begin at once to live, and count each day as a life of its own.

The man who has lived fully today is not robbed by tomorrow's uncertainty.

Finish each day complete, owing nothing to the next.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

What reason advises stands firm and lifts the soul.

Feelings argue with the weather. Principle does not move
when the storm comes.

Anchor to what is true, not to how you feel today.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

One good man, to me, is worth a whole crowd.

Do not perform for the many; live as if the wisest single man were watching.

Satisfy the one true judge, not the loud many.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Treat each day as a complete life.

Finish it owing nothing to tomorrow and regretting
nothing from this morning.

Close the day clean and the years take care of themselves.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

You control your choices; the rest only borrows your
peace if you let it.

The sailor does not curse the sea; he trims the sail.

Adjust what is yours and let the sea be the sea's.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

We suffer more often in imagination than in fact.

Half your dread is for trouble that never arrives.

Carry only the weight actually on your back.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Rehearse loss while you still have everything.

The grief you have already faced in the mind loses its power in the world.

Practice the hard day on an easy one.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Complaint is the language of the powerless.

Every minute on blame is a minute stolen from the fix.

Spend on the solution, not the story.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

What reason approves stands firm when feeling changes
with the weather.

Principle does not move when the storm comes.

Anchor to what is true, not to how you feel today.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Fortune fears the man who has already made peace with loss.

What can be taken from you holds no power once you have released your grip.

Hold lightly, and you cannot be robbed.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Read your life as if you were already old and looking back.

From that seat, the small worries shrink and the real things stand out.

Live now what your older self will wish you had.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The wound is not in the event but in the opinion you add to it.

Drop the verdict and the sting often goes with it.

Question the story before you suffer it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The mind that fears death has never truly looked at it.

Study the thing you dread and it shrinks to its real,
smaller size.

Face it once, clearly, and be free of it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Want things to happen as they do, and your days go smoothly.

Fighting what has already arrived is a war you cannot win.

Meet the real, not the wished-for.

Yours faithfully,

Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father